

VERIQO Legal Positioning Statement

The language VERIQO uses about itself, and the language it will not use. This is a discipline document: it exists so that no VERIQO document, proposal, dossier, or conversation overstates what the technology establishes.

This document is not legal advice, and nothing in it constitutes a legal opinion. See `VERIQO_JURISDICTION_DISCLAIMER.md`.

1. The positioning, in one sentence

VERIQO is technical evidence infrastructure. It establishes the integrity, provenance, custody, and lineage of records and of the decisions grounded on them, in a form a third party can verify independently. It does not determine legal effect, admissibility, or evidential weight — those are questions of applicable law, forum rules, and independent legal judgment.

2. Language VERIQO uses

Use	Because
"Court and arbitration evidence support "	Describes assisting a process, not guaranteeing an outcome in it.
" Independently verifiable record"	Precisely true: a separate binary verifies it without trusting us.
" Tamper-evident audit trail"	Accurate: alteration is <i>detectable</i> . Not "tamper-proof".
"Establishes integrity and lineage "	The actual technical claim.
"Evidence infrastructure around electronic transferable record events"	Positions VERIQO beside the legal instrument, not as it.
" Designed to support [obligation]"	Honest about intent without asserting compliance.

3. Language VERIQO does not use

Never say	Why
"Court-admissible" / "admissible evidence"	Admissibility is decided by a court under its own rules. No vendor can confer it.
"Legally binding"	VERIQO records facts about records; it does not create legal obligations.
"Tamper-proof"	Overclaims. Data can be destroyed or truncated; what VERIQO guarantees is <i>detection</i> .
"MLETR-compliant" / "MLETR-qualified"	A legal qualification requiring jurisdiction-specific analysis VERIQO has not obtained.
"Proves the document is genuine/truthful"	Integrity is not veracity. An intact document can be false.
"Guarantees you will win the dispute" (in any phrasing)	Not a claim any evidence system can make.
"Certified" / "accredited" (unqualified)	VERIQO holds no certification or accreditation.

Never say	Why
"Production-qualified" (at present)	Not true today. See the Readiness Tier Framework.
"Fully cryptographically independent verifier" (unqualified)	See §5.

4. The integrity/veracity distinction

The most important line in this document.

VERIQO can establish: that this artifact is byte-identical to the one submitted; that its custody chain is unbroken; that the decision cited evidence which genuinely existed and was finalized; that the audit ledger has not been altered; and — with key distribution — which key attested to it.

VERIQO cannot establish: that the artifact's *contents are true*. A surveyor's report can be perfectly intact, in unbroken custody, cryptographically signed, and simply wrong. A hash proves nothing about honesty.

Any VERIQO material that blurs this line is defective and should be corrected.

5. Positioning the independent verifier

The verifier is a genuine differentiator and should be described accurately:

VERIQO's independent verifier is a separate binary that checks a dossier package using only the file itself — package hash, manifest integrity, raw evidence hashes, custody chain, Merkle root, lineage against the independently-parsed ledger, and the ledger's own hash chain from genesis. **Signature and key-state verification are cryptographically real when the verifying party supplies a trusted key registry obtained through their own channel;** absent such a registry those two checks report SKIP — explicitly, never a false pass.

Do not describe verification as "complete" or "fully cryptographic" without stating the trusted-key-registry condition. Do not describe the HTTP verification route as independent verification — it runs in the server whose claims may be in dispute.

6. Positioning MLETR and electronic transferable records

VERIQO has not obtained a legal opinion confirming MLETR conformance in any jurisdiction, and cannot produce one. Repeated attempts to verify this against primary legal sources are documented in `docs/VERIQO_MLETR_EBL_CONFORMANCE_MAPPING_V0_2.md`.

The approved formulation, to be used verbatim where the topic arises including with investors:

"VERIQO is designed to provide technical evidence infrastructure around electronic transferable record events; legal effect and jurisdiction-specific MLETR qualification remain subject to applicable law, platform rules and independent legal review."

Note what this does: it states a real technical capability, and locates legal qualification where it belongs — with applicable law and independent counsel. It neither claims conformance nor pretends the subject is irrelevant.

Scope note: MLETR qualification is a *vertical* legal question affecting electronic transferable records specifically. It is not a gating condition on VERIQO's broader applicability to maritime intelligence, commodity risk, insurance evidence, dispute evidence, trade finance, and supply chain — none of which depend on it.

7. Positioning readiness

Use the four-tier framework (`docs/VERIQO_READINESS_TIER_FRAMEWORK.md`), never a single word. "Pilot-ready" alone is exactly the imprecision that framework was written to correct. State the tier, and state what is still open at the tier above.

Never present `READY_FOR_REAL_QUALIFICATION` as qualification. The former means the internal harness passes; the latter requires an external engagement that has not happened. Conflating them in a proposal would be a material misrepresentation.

8. In dossiers

Every dossier carries a Limitations section stating what it does not establish. It is not boilerplate and must not be trimmed for presentation. A dossier that omits its limitations misrepresents itself regardless of how accurate its other content is.

9. Applying this

When drafting any customer-facing material, check each claim:

1. Is it about **integrity/lineage** (VERIQO's domain) or about **truth, legality, or outcome** (not VERIQO's domain)?
2. Does it depend on an operational precondition — key distribution, TLS configuration, external qualification — that is not stated?
3. Would it still be defensible if read aloud by opposing counsel?

If any answer is uncomfortable, the claim needs rewording, not a footnote.